

Spring Term Newsletter 2016

The U10 football team rounded off the term in dramatic style, winning a tense and exciting penalty shoot out at the Claremont 5 a-side Indoor Football Tournament on Monday 21st March to clinch 3rd place overall.

Well done Ben, Dan, Hayden, Himmat, Jamie, Kristian, Toby and Tommy, you thoroughly entertained the spectators and played so well as a team.

Westward pupils have truly shone this term across so many areas of the curriculum and have enjoyed taking part in a varied programme of events which have included numerous class trips, sports fixtures including the Westward netball tournaments, an author visit, internet safety, museum and drama workshops and the inter house quiz and chess tournaments.

Without the dedication from staff, parents and the WHSA members to go that extra mile and help plan and run each event, the pupils at Westward would not be exposed to such a rich curriculum. Thank you to everyone for their hard work and continued support of the school.

Our current Year 6 pupils worked exceptionally hard during this year's senior school entrance exams, achieving one of our best set of exam results to date. Indeed 90% of the cohort achieved their first choice of school and received an offer of a place at all the schools they sat. They are a very talented group of children with each and every one of them deserving their individual successes.

An impressive 17 scholarships were awarded to 11 different children in the class with 11 of the scholarships being awarded for academic excellence. Scholarships were also awarded for art, music and drama.

Cross Country is becoming an increasingly popular sport at Westward and pupils in Year 6 have enjoyed taking part in several competitive events this term which have included both the Regional ISA, Claremont and Surrey Schools' Cross Country events.

A special mention and congratulations must go to Rebecca in Year 6 who came 8th in the ISA Regional Cross Country which secured her a place in the National Finals to represent the London South team. Rebecca performed extremely well at National level, scoring vital points for the London South team which placed them
2nd
overall. An experience I'm sure Rebecca will not forget in a hurry.

Congratulations to Ben in Year 6 who came 5th in the National Cyclecross event and we wish

him all the best of luck for the season ahead.

A big well done must also go to the hockey and tag rugby teams who played so well at both of the ISA regional events this term, just narrowly missing out on winning the tournament on both occasions.

The Year 6 general knowledge team consisting of Louis, Phoebe, Sofia, Sophie and Rebecca travelled to Weston Green at the end of February for their first round match in the Rotary quiz and I am pleased to announce that after a super start and nail biting final few rounds, Westward came out victorious against the Weston Green team and are now through to the next stage of the competition with a home tie against Cranmere Primary School early next term.

The Westward choir and orchestra members led by Miss Luksch have had another magnificent term with notable public performances at the Children's Trust Concert, The Daneshill "Voice Power Singing" day, Whiteley Village and the Easter Service at St Andrew's Church.

At the Children's Trust concert the 41 choir members sang their four songs passionately and were a great joy to watch. The programme was full of variety, especially "Sing" by Gary Barlow and the Military Wives song "Stronger Together". Both were sung from the heart and were deeply moving for the audience.

An instrumental piece by Isobel on piano, Freddy and Monty on violin, Chloe on cello plus the final solo performance by Isobel on piano, demonstrated outstanding musical talent.

Chloe and Isobel in Year 5 were selected to represent Westward in the LVS Ascot Music Festival this term where Chloe gained

3rd

place with her cello piece and

4th

place with her violin.

Isobel was successful in winning Gold medals in the 'Piano Advanced Level' and 'Folksong Higher Level' categories as well as 'Overall Best Musician of the Festival'. Many congratulations!

Our Easter Service was a bright and joyous occasion and many thanks must go to Mrs Williams and Year 6 for leading the service, to Miss Luksch for the music and to all the classes for their individual contributions.

During our "Around the World" week, a theme chosen by last year's School Council, an

amazing £471.34 was raised over two days for Type 1 Diabetes, bringing our overall Diabetes charity total for the academic year to £782.47. Lots of fun was had by all during the week and we were very lucky that the weather held.

I would like to take this opportunity to thank the outgoing School Council members for being the voice for their class and for all the contributions they have made to the Westward community over the last few terms.

The scooter/bike shelter and light in the games shed are very soon to be installed.

Thank you Ana (Nursery), Theo (Reception), Evie (Year 1), Katie (Year 2), Laurence (Year 3), Sarah (Year 4), Arjun (Year 5), Danny (Year 6) and to Mrs Webb for running the School Council meetings.

I look forward to unveiling the new School Council for the Summer Term.

A fantastic time was had by Year 3 & 4 during their recent School Journey to New Barn in Dorset. Despite heavy rain on the first day the children enjoyed a whole host of activities which included orienteering, making shadow puppets, visiting Monkey World, ten pin bowling and the legendary 'Pirate Shindig'. A big thank you to all the staff who planned and accompanied the children over the three days.

Year 5 spent an exciting afternoon at Reed's School to take part in their 'Launch Car Challenge'. During the event each pair had to design and make a car which could be launched by compressed air. The children thoroughly enjoyed the experience of working in the 'FutureTech' lab and learnt many joining methods and techniques. They particularly liked working with what the children described as "grown up" tools!

Once the cars were made each car raced off against each other in the hall with Ben and Himmat's car being victorious.

Ben and Himmat will return to Reed's in May for the Launch Car Challenge Final. This time they will have a new design specification and will be racing their vehicle against nine other schools. The building of the new car will begin at the start of the Summer Term.

Congratulations to the following children who were awarded prizes at our end of term assembly.

Year Group

Handwriting

Cup

Caring Cup

Maths Cup

Literacy Cup

Nursery

L. Blake

F. Jennings

Reception

O. Stonebridge

R. Apted

Year 1

E. Iliev

W. Dorudi

Year 2

S. Savarino

H. Simpson

Year 3

M. Mantio

E. Best

J. Udueni

N. Newman

Year 4

L. Hooper

C. Wyeth

E. Kang

A.Needs

Presentation

Cup

Service

to the Community

Year 5

A.Thompson

I.Wright

B. Tabberner

S. Ahmad

Year 6

E. Urrutia

O. Peacock

B. Bisson

C. Bolton

Football Cup: M. Hicks

Rugby Award: L. Wilby

Netball Cup: S. Zafar

Attendance Cup - Year 3

Following the Inter House Quiz and Chess tournaments the House Competition totals are as follows;

St Patrick's - 35 points

St George's - 65 points

St David's - 100 points

St Andrew's - 105 points

Only five points between St David's and St Andrew's which makes for a very exciting finish with the Swimming Gala and Sports Day events to come.

After several staff discussions it has been decided to change the way that holiday homework is set from this Easter. There will no longer be holiday homework set during half term and end of term homework will consist mainly of home reading or preparation for examination days such as Lamda or ESB.

The only exception will be the Year 5 to Year 6 exam preparation homework which will stay the same from the Summer holidays up until the exams are finished.

Everyone needs a break and children need time to unwind without the pressure of homework hanging over them. Children need space to develop their creativity and have some downtime and that is what holidays are for. However, it is important to encourage children into the habit of reading for pleasure.

A good break spent with family and friends is needed to recharge everyone's batteries. Rest, relax and do the things they enjoy.

If you would like your child to keep their skills sharp during the holidays then there are lots of age appropriate revision books available from local book stores or online. The children may also like to access their Purple Mash accounts from home, through which they can explore online games and activities covering the whole curriculum.

Wishing you all a very restful Easter break and remember to keep yourself updated with the latest news by viewing our school website.

Let's hope the sun continues to shine!

Shelley Stevenson